



## Profile

### Personal information

|                      |                       |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| Name                 | Lomole, Jonathan Kiri |
| Share different name | No                    |
| Birthdate            | 01/05/2004            |

### Contact details

|                   |                                                                          |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Email, Phone      | lomolejonathan@gmail.com, +254.797119890, Mobile, +254.741933824, Mobile |
| Permanent address | Wanyee Rd Nairobi, Nairobi, KEN                                          |

### Demographics

|                        |                                           |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Gender Identity        | Male                                      |
| Sex                    | Male                                      |
| Pronouns               | He/Him                                    |
| Military status        | None                                      |
| Hispanic or Latino/a/x | No                                        |
| Race                   | <b>Black or African American (Africa)</b> |

### Language

|                              |                                                    |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| English                      | Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home                 |
| Swahili                      | First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home |
| Turkish                      | Speak, Read, Write                                 |
| Other, South Sudanese Arabic | Spoken at Home                                     |
| Other, Bari                  | Spoken at Home                                     |

Geography and nationality

|                    |                                  |
|--------------------|----------------------------------|
| Citizenship status | Citizen of non-U.S. country      |
| Birthplace         | Nairobi, Kenya 1 year or less US |
| Other citizenships | South Sudan                      |
| Current US Visa    | None                             |
| Intended US Visa   | F-1 Student                      |

Common App fee waiver

|                      |                                   |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Fee waiver requested | Yes, Signed: Jonathan Kiri Lomole |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------|

# Family

## Household

**Parents** Married  
**Home** Legal Guardian

## Parent 1

### Father

**Name** Mr. Manase W Lomole  
**Email, Phone** lomolewaya@gmail.com, +211.922-786-992, Mobile  
**Occupation** Military service (career), Retired  
**Education** Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent)

## Parent 2

### Mother

**Name** Mrs. Mary R Erasto  
**Email, Phone** maryropierasto57@gmail.com, +254.741933824, Mobile  
**Occupation** Farmer or rancher, Self-Employed  
**Education** Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent)

## Legal guardian

### Brother

**Name** Emmanuel M Lomole  
**Email, Phone** emmanuelmarsuk@gmail.com, +254.708317343, Mobile  
**Education** Some high/secondary school

## Siblings

Joy Luba Lomole, Age 40

Anne Pita Lomole, Age 38

Samuel Pinyale Lomole, Age 37

Daniel Binya Lomole, Age 34

John Soma Lomole, Age 31

# Education

## Current or most recent secondary school

**Light Academy Nairobi, Nairobi, Nairobi, Kenya, Independent (01/2018 - 04/2022)**

|                        |                           |
|------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>Boarding school</b> | Yes: Living at school     |
| <b>Progression</b>     | Did or will take gap year |
| <b>Graduation Date</b> | 04/2022                   |

## Colleges & universities

## Grades

**Rank** 2 / 137, Unweighted

## Current or most recent year courses

| First trimester            | Second trimester           | Third trimester            |
|----------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| MATH - Mathematics - (REG) | MATH - Mathematics - (REG) | MATH - Mathematics - (REG) |
| BIOL - Biology - (REG)     | BIOL - Biology - (REG)     | BIOL - Biology - (REG)     |
| CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)   | CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)   | CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)   |
| PHYS - Physics - (REG)     | PHYS - Physics - (REG)     | PHYS - Physics - (REG)     |
| ENG - English - (REG)      | ENG - English - (REG)      | ENG - English - (REG)      |
| HIST - History - (REG)     | HIST - History - (REG)     | HIST - History - (REG)     |
| OTH/ELE - Business - (REG) | OTH/ELE - Business - (REG) | OTH/ELE - Business - (REG) |
| LANG - Kiswahili - (REG)   | LANG - Kiswahili - (REG)   | LANG - Kiswahili - (REG)   |

## Honors

**68th of 831,026 students who sat for KCSE 2021, recognized on front page of Nation, Standard papers** National 12

|                                                                                                                      |                                  |               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------|
| <b>Owlypia Intellectuals: 1st Knowledge &amp; Impromptu Challenges; 3rd Speech Craft &amp; Team Spirit Challenge</b> | National, International          | 11            |
| <b>2nd place, American Mathematics Competitions 10 2020</b>                                                          | School, State/Regional, National | 11            |
| <b>Record holder for best performance in Business Studies SUKELLEMO joint exams</b>                                  | School, State/Regional           | 9, 10, 11, 12 |
| <b>Salutatorian &amp; Most Impactful Student Class of 2021</b>                                                       | School                           | 12            |

## Community-based organizations

|                     |                          |
|---------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>CBO 1</b>        | EducationUSA             |
| <b>Counselor</b>    | Ms. Jennifer Maende      |
| <b>Email, Phone</b> | nairobi@educationusa.org |

## Future plans

Business executive (management, administrator), Doctorate

# Testing

## Leaving Exams

|                               |    |                                                                  |
|-------------------------------|----|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mathematics</b>            | A  | 03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE) |
| <b>English</b>                | A- | 03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE) |
| <b>Kiswahili</b>              | A  | 03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE) |
| <b>Physics</b>                | A  | 03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE) |
| <b>Biology</b>                | A  | 03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE) |
| <b>Chemistry</b>              | A  | 03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE) |
| <b>Business Studies</b>       | A  | 03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE) |
| <b>History and Government</b> | A  | 03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE) |

# Activities

## Internship

PG  
Year  
40 hr/wk, 28 wk/yr  
Continue

### **Intern, SECURAI OY**

Data collection & entry, used to prepare reports; Scheduling meetings for the manager; Led customer relations, reducing customer attrition by 30%

## Social Justice

9, 10, 11, 12  
Break  
48 hr/wk, 16 wk/yr  
Continue

### **Community Volunteer, Humanitarian Assistance for South Sudan (HASS)**

Led mental health awareness campaigns in Kakuma Refugee camp; Trained by UNICEF to provide MHPSS to refugee teenagers to help battle anxiety & PTSD

## Other Club/Activity

9, 10, 11, 12  
School  
20 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr  
Continue

### **Founder, Tujengane MENTAL Health Group**

Planned annual wellbeing week; Organized training of wellbeing ambassadors to better wellbeing & resilience among students; Raised LGBTQ+ awareness

## Other Club/Activity

9, 10, 11, 12  
School  
10 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr  
Continue

### **Treasurer, Junior Achievers Club**

Initiated monthly food bazaars, profits used to fund low-income students in school; Arranged seminars to educate members on cryptocurrency & investing

## Other Club/Activity

9, 10, 11, 12, PG  
Break  
20 hr/wk, 16 wk/yr  
Continue

### **Co-founder, Handmade Scrolls, Kenya**

Made & sold leather journals, gave profits to my aunt in Kakuma; Gave 50 journals annually to refugees to encourage cognitive journaling

## Athletics: Club



9, 10, 11, 12  
School, Break  
21 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr  
Continue

**Rugby, Captain Junior Team, Backline senior team, Stormers Rugby Team**  
Captained team to win Oshwal & Mombasa Opens in 2019, won MVP in both; promoted anti-doping initiatives in team; Trained & tutored junior teammates

## Dance

9, 10, 11, 12, PG  
School, Break  
21 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr  
Continue

**Team Leader Team USA, International Festival of Language and Culture (IFLC)**  
Performed in IFLC Houston & Los Angeles in 2019; choreographed Swahili dance performed in IFLC Germany 2022; Headed school's Cultural Day committee

## Student Govt./Politics

12  
School  
6 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr  
Continue

**Co-President, Light Academy Student Council( LASC)**  
Introduced admission fees, raising funds for clubs; Arranged interschool charities; Pushed PTA to double scholarships given to low-income students

## Religious

11, 12  
School  
6 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr  
Continue

**Treasurer, Light Academy Christian Union( LACU)**  
Started evangelical & mental health awareness missions in Kibra Slum; Worked with Muslim community in school to mobilize donation of \$800 to the slum

## Foreign Language

10, 11, 12, PG  
Break  
7 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr  
Continue

**Member, Turkish Language Club**  
Represented school in 19th Turkish Olympiad; Translated Swahili tales to Turkish, published in local paper; performed Turkish dance on Cultural day

# Writing

## Personal essay

Share an essay on any topic of your choice. It can be one you've already written, one that responds to a different prompt, or one of your own design.

**"Jonathan! Why are you crying?" My aunt asked me as I walked into the house back from school.**

**"They called me an orphan. Again, "I told her as I fell to my knees and cried.**

**This had been the norm. My schoolmates would make fun of me because I claimed to have parents they never saw. It pained me because, though I had parents, I barely knew them as we hardly met. At age 2, my parents left me with my aunt in Kakuma, Kenya, so I'd get an education here. They returned to South Sudan as part of the South Sudanese liberation movement. Despite having seven siblings, I was separated from them. The oldest four lived in Sudan, while the other three lived in Nairobi, Kenya.**

**Growing up alone, I wasn't taught the basics of life, like being potty trained, which I taught myself in grade one. Though I stayed with my aunt, she was hardly home as she'd be pulling double shifts as a cleaner at the local prison to provide for her children and me. I didn't know how to socialize as I didn't have siblings to play with or talk to. Despite having cousins, they'd bully me for not being man enough, as I often cried. I was too scared to stand up to them and suffered silently.**

**Growing up alone harbored resentment in me. I was mad at myself for existing, my parents for leaving, and my siblings for not being there. I became anxious because my parents lived in a war-torn nation and could be killed in the conflict, leaving me orphaned. I never believed in myself as I thought I wasn't good enough and that is why my parents left me with my aunt. Is it because I have eczema? Or is it my two-toned face?" I pondered.**

**In grade 5, I got the chance to meet my father as he visited me at my aunt's place. We only spent a day together, and before he left, he gifted me a journal. "Jot everything down. Before it's full, I'll be back," he said.**

**I did as he instructed. Daily, I'd write about my fears, what triggered them, my dreams, my sorrows, and something I appreciated from that day. This subconsciously changed me. Through journaling, I believed I was communicating with my father. Behind the words, I felt he was listening to me, and I was no longer alone. Articulating my thoughts on paper made me communicate effectively. It enabled me to plan conversations that I'd hold in school to help me socialize. I even managed to write an explanation of my 'orphan' status that I told my classmates, and they finally believed me. I became**

**courageous and finally stood up to my cousins, who stopped mocking me. It helped me put into perspective my inner critic, which lowered my self-esteem. Journaling when I was down and later reflecting on it showed me I was more than my negative thoughts. It calmed my anger and anxiety and enabled me to appreciate my appearance and my family members, who, though in absentia, was alive and would be there for me if circumstances were better.**

**In seventh grade, I filled out my first journal. Unfortunately, another civil war broke out in South Sudan, which made it impossible for my father to come to visit again that year. Thus, I started to make journals with threads and pieces of borrowed paper. I had to continue journaling because it enabled me to overcome anxiety and low self-esteem, communicate effectively and believe in myself.**

**Journaling not only became my identity but also gave me hope. Writing on a new page made me believe I was more than a refugee. This is a belief I aspire to share with other refugee children by providing psychosocial services to them through cognitive journaling and other forms of therapy.**

## **Additional information**

### **Education Background**

In grade 8, I was sponsored by a doctor in the hospital my aunt worked in to go to join a boarding school in Kawangware Slum Nairobi. There, I sat for my KCPE where I emerged as the top South Sudanese student in the country. I then applied to Light Academy Nairobi where I was awarded an academic merit-based scholarship. The scholarship also catered to my IFLC trips to the USA.

### **Family Status**

I have 7 siblings. The other 2 not listed in the family section are Emmanuel Lomole and David Lomole who are 29 and 25 years old respectively.

### **Guardian Status**

After I relocated to Nairobi in grade 8, I lived with my brother, Emmanuel Lomole over my short school

breaks and after high school thus becoming my current guardian. He is also the other Co-founder of Handmade Scrolls.

### **Activities List**

-Over my long holidays, I'd go to Kakuma to volunteer at HASS. Due to the high cost of transport from Nairobi to Kakuma, I'd use goat and sheep trucks to go to and come from Kakuma.

- Aside from participating in IFLC USA in 2019, I also participated in the following activities in the IFLC Club ;

1. Dance performance at 17th IFLC held at Karen Hub, Nairobi in April 2019
2. Dance performance on International Museum Day 2021 at the Nairobi National Museum
3. IFLC 2020 Virtual event (International recognition)
4. Creating video performances for Umit Nagmeleri Youtube Channel 2021 (International recognition)
5. Creating video performances for the Colors of Voices Singing contest 2021 (International recognition)
6. Dance performance at the IFLC Colors of voices International Singing Contest in 2021 (International recognition)

-In Junior Achievers Club, I also organized for members to have job shadowing at Safaricom PLC to educate them on financial literacy. I also led the club in being trained in the following modules hosted by Entrepreneurs Desk ( virtually) in 2020; Business Planning, Business 101, and Business Law and Ethics.

## **Education progression**

## Details

### Education progression details

Did or will take gap year

## Required explanation

### Education progression

After my KCSE, I continued working with my brother on Handmade Scrolls. I'd do deliveries over the weekend, collect leather and packaging for the scrolls, make the journals, and use social media platforms to expand our markets. My brother would give me my share of the profits, which I sent back to my aunt in Kakuma.

My school's dance teacher recalled me in April. I was to choreograph and teach the junior team an African dance to be performed in IFLC Germany. After two weeks of intense training, the team was ready to leave for Germany. I was offered the chance to perform at IFLC New York 2022. However, since I was no longer on a scholarship, I lacked the funds to pay for the trip.

I signed up with EducationUSA in June. I was one of the forty students selected, from a pool of 2500 students, to join the college access program. The program helped me work on my college application so I'd obtain a scholarship to study in the USA.

Aside from the CBO, I interned at SECURE OY, a Finnish data analytics firm in Nairobi. I was tasked with data collection and entry, which I used in preparing reports on the market's viability. I also worked in the client relations department, where I made query forms to get feedback from clients and improve our services. We improved our services and reduced customer attrition by 30%.

# Northwestern University questions

## General

|                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Entry term</b>                                                                      | Fall 2023                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Admission plan</b>                                                                  | Early Decision                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Financial aid</b>                                                                   | Yes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Early Decision Agreement</b>                                                        | Yes%, I have read and understand my rights and responsibilities under the Early Decision Process. I wish to be considered as an Early Decision candidate at Northwestern University. I also understand that with an Early Decision offer of admissions%, this institution may share my name and my early commitment with other institutions. Lomole Jonathan Kiri |
| <b>Fee Waiver</b>                                                                      | Yes, I have been granted a fee waiver; the application fee presents a financial hardship.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Do you want us to consider SAT or ACT scores in our review of your application?</b> | No                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

## Academics

|                  |                              |
|------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>School(s)</b> | College of Arts and Sciences |
| <b>Major</b>     | Psychology                   |

## Contacts

|                           |                                   |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Previously applied</b> | No                                |
| <b>Contact 1</b>          | Online Northwestern YouTube video |
| <b>Contact date 1</b>     | 2020                              |
| <b>Contact 2</b>          | College fair                      |
| <b>Contact name 2</b>     | In-person                         |
| <b>Contact date 2</b>     | 2022                              |
| <b>Text consent</b>       | Yes                               |

## Family

|                        |    |
|------------------------|----|
| <b>Sibling applied</b> | No |
|------------------------|----|

|                                                   |                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Relatives attended member</b>                  | No                                                   |
| <b>Employee reported on CA</b>                    | No                                                   |
| <b>Sibling Educational level question</b>         | Yes                                                  |
| <b>Please specify number of siblings Ed level</b> | 7                                                    |
| <b>Sibling First/Given name 1</b>                 | Joy                                                  |
| <b>Sibling Last/Family/Surname 1</b>              | Lomole                                               |
| <b>Sibling Educational level 1</b>                | Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent) |
| <b>Sibling First/Given name 2</b>                 | Anne                                                 |
| <b>Sibling Last/Family/Surname 2</b>              | Lomole                                               |
| <b>Sibling Educational level 2</b>                | Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent) |
| <b>Sibling First/Given name 3</b>                 | Samuel                                               |
| <b>Sibling Last/Given name 3</b>                  | Lomole                                               |
| <b>Sibling Educational level 3</b>                | Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent) |
| <b>Sibling First/Given name 4</b>                 | Daniel                                               |
| <b>Sibling Last/Family/Surname 4</b>              | Lomole                                               |
| <b>Sibling Educational level 4</b>                | Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent) |
| <b>Sibling First/Given name 5</b>                 | John                                                 |
| <b>Sibling Last/Family/Surname 5</b>              | Lomole                                               |
| <b>Sibling Educational level 5</b>                | Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent) |
| <b>Sibling First/Given name 6</b>                 | Emmanuel                                             |
| <b>Sibling Last/Family/Surname 6</b>              | Lomole                                               |
| <b>Sibling Educational level</b>                  | Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent) |

6

**Sibling First/Given name** David

7

**Sibling Last/Given name** Lomole

7

**Sibling Educational level** Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent)

7

## Test

**"Why Northwestern"** Yes

**Statement : While other parts of your application give us a sense of who you are, we are also excited to hear more about how you see yourself engaging with the larger Northwestern community. In 300 words or less, help us understand how you might engage specific resources, opportunities, and/or communities here. We are curious about what these specifics are, as well as how they may enrich your time at Northwestern and beyond. Do you plan to complete the "Why Northwestern" Statement? (We strongly encourage a response, as your answer will help us connect the dots across your application to imagine what kind of college student you might become.)**

**"Why Northwestern" Statement:****Dear 2022 Jonathan,**

**It's 2024. I've just returned from the GESI program in Uganda. Providing MHPSS with HASS at Kakuma equipped me with skills to pass on the same hope I received through journaling in Bidi Bidi Refugee**



**Camp, Uganda. I'm on track to beat the pandemic facing many refugee children; psychological disorders.**

**The best decision you made was to study Psychology at Northwestern University. Every day at the Weinberg College of Arts and Science feels like turning a new page in your journal, opening a world full of possibilities. Office hours with Professor Richard Zinberg gave me a deeper insight into anxiety disorders and improved CBT models to prevent anxiety disorders among children. Advanced supervised research empowered me to discover ways of improving CBT and not basing it on gaslighting. Interning at Northwestern Settlement fulfilled my desire to provide low-cost mental health services to underprivileged children and disrupt generational poverty in Evanston.**

**The AND in Northwestern's DNA makes me believe we were separated at birth. Northwestern enabled me to minor in entrepreneurship and, combining this with skills from the Jumpstart at the Garage, I managed to make the Handmade Scrolls more profitable.**

**Unfortunately, we danced for only 27 hours at NUMD but we'll hit that 30-hour mark next year. Performing Avule Kile Amassngo at Jabulani was good but not as good as marching through the arch and watching the sunset over Lakefill. I joined Cookology and now I make lokum and baklava for the ASA meetings just like the ones you had at the Turkish Club. Northwestern made you a catalyst to start and continue the provision of psychosocial services to more refugees. Inshallah, we will receive the Nansen Refugee Award in 2028.**

**Yours faithfully,**

**2024 Jonathan**

**Lokum - Turkish delight**

**Baklava- Turkish pastry**

**Inshallah- God willing**

## **Affirmations**

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: <http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.

## **LETTER OF RECOMMENDATION FOR LOMOLE JONATHAN**

### **Distinctive Characteristics**

- In my ten years as a counselor, I've interacted with many exemplary students, but Jonathan Lomole stands out as the finest of them all. He is an exceptional leader, empathetic, dauntless, ambitious, and a trailblazer. It is rare to meet a student who connects deeply with people and has a wonderful sense of human nature as Jonathan has. This makes him enrich both his peers and the school faculty. He radiates joy and every second spent with him is priceless.

### **Academic and Intellectual Growth and Trends**

- Jonathan is one of the five students who managed to get into the school on an academic merit-based scholarship. After every KCPE, national exam to transition into high school, the school offers merit scholarships to 5 students. In his year, Jonathan beat over 5000 students to receive the scholarship. To maintain the scholarship, one should not get below an average of A-. Jonathan managed to maintain an average of A throughout his school journey getting an A- only once. This was on the rare occasions when his mother visited him. Unfortunately, his mother was critically ill. The school released Jonathan every weekend to visit her till she got better. Nonetheless, he bounced off stronger after his mother recovered and returned to South Sudan.
- Jonathan also had an aptitude for setting the path for the next generation. In 2020, he opted to compete in The Owlypia Intellectuals Challenge rather than the World Scholar's Cup. Jonathan believed Owlypia was a more rigorous competition. He wanted to set the tone right by competing and succeeding in Owlypia so his juniors would join it the next year. However, the lockdown started a week before the competition, preventing it from taking place as planned. Seeing classes had been moved online, he, together with other students who were to compete in Owlypia, suggested making the competition online. I worked with the organizers and successfully managed to hold the competition virtually in November 2020. Jonathan did set the tone for his junior as he articulated his ideas with conviction and passion in the debates. He led his team to 3rd in Team Spirit and was awarded 1st in Knowledge and Impromptu Challenges. Though he qualified for the global round, he didn't participate in it because of the packed academic school year in 2021. He, however, encouraged more juniors to participate in Owlypia and other new competitions to put themselves to test and expand their horizons.

### **Areas of significant impact**

- Jonathan started the school's first mental health awareness club weeks after joining grade 9. He approached me with the idea which I then facilitated. He began with group therapies. However, the first session had fewer than five people. Seeing the stigmatization of mental health illnesses among the students, he started campaigns to destigmatize mental health illnesses and promote well-being. He began 5-minute mindfulness-based interventions during assembly which was meant with strong resentment by senior students. However, as he continued with them, students became more accustomed to it and even requested to increase it to 10 minutes. He made posters with well-being tips and planned well-being weeks where he invited psychotherapists to educate students on psychosocial diseases. He organized training of well-being ambassadors in school through Worth-it Positive Education CIC's well-being ambassadors program. This not only increased resilience and well-being among students but also reduced bullying and substance abuse in the school.
- Jonathan was also the youngest Rugby captain the school has ever had. He led the school to win its first-ever rugby cup in the Oshwal and Mombasa opens. Jonathan influenced his classmates to participate more in rugby, tripling the team's number to 27. He managed to reduce doping and substance abuse cases in rugby to zero. In the absence of the coach, he trained his junior teammates. He carefully balanced his team duties with his studies and encouraged all his teammates to do the same. It didn't matter whether he had a big rugby game the day before, his assignments would be perfectly done the next day. He thoughtfully worked ahead so that when it was time to play he would commit fully. This is a trait that is seen across all players under him.

### **Additional Comments**

The one thing I'll remember Jonathan for is the handmade leather journal he gave me after finishing high school. Jonathan has an extraordinary intellectual capacity without a shred of pretension. He has shown diligence and an incomparable drive in everything he does. Growing up without his parents enabled him to mature way beyond his years. He cares deeply about his friends, family, and the larger global community. His influence has been invaluable to the school. I enthusiastically recommend him. I believe he'll be a great resource to his peers. He will contribute positively academically and socially to your institution.

M.Senyangwa,  
School Counselor,  
Light Academy.

## **LETTER OF RECOMMENDATION FOR LOMOLE JONATHAN**

### **Student's experience with the curriculum**

- I was honored to have taught Jonathan Business Studies throughout his four years of high school. Business Studies is a rigorous subject, covering everything from Finance to Accounting to Economics. Memorization of the content doesn't guarantee success. Nonetheless, Jonathan combined memorization, deep insight, and enthusiasm for the subject to contribute to his success. He was among the 15 students in his year to take Business Studies. He is also the record holder for best performance in Business Studies SUKELLEMO joint exams, an exam done by over 20 schools and 2000 students in Kenya every year.

### **Academic Characteristics**

- Jonathan's passion and curiosity for the subject made him stand out from his peers. In Economics, Jonathan had read ahead of his class, grasping all economics concepts from grade 9 to grade 12 by grade 10. His desire to learn how people make decisions drove him to read Nudge by Richard Thaler to get a deeper insight into behavioral economics despite it not being part of the syllabus. He would persistently ask pertinent questions that we would discuss, making the class more lively. He'd always meet me on Saturdays for extra hours to discuss questions he failed on assignments and how to answer questions he got in a better way.
- Jonathan was always at the forefront of making his classmates perform better. Jonathan brought in a competitive spirit by initiating row competitions in class where he'd ask questions to random people in a row. The row with the correct answers would get points. At the end of the week, I would reward the row by buying them candy at the school cafeteria. The competition helped his classmates not only remember things but also understand them. The method saw the class mean drastically rise from 65% to 85% by the end of grade 11. In group discussions, he paired himself with weaker students. He motivated the weaker students in his group and got extra revision materials to help them. His warm and non-judgmental attitude made his peers feel comfortable around him even when they didn't understand finance concepts. He transferred his hard work and thoughtfulness to his peers. His deskmate Ali was once a poor performer in Business Studies. However, after Jonathan became his deskmate, he extended his helping hand to Ali. Ali was able to move from Cs to As through Jonathan's help and once beat him in a CAT.
- Jonathan's resilience and relentless desire to be better enabled him to understand accounting. When I introduced accounting, he struggled with it as he failed to correctly balance a book on the board in front of the class. He was the first student to attempt the challenge. He listened to feedback from his classmates and was open to their suggestions on how to balance the book. He learned from his attempt and from his classmates. This experience not only helped Jonathan get better at accounting but was also helpful to his classmates who saw him struggle with a concept, something they hardly saw. He did so openly without embarrassment, setting a tone for the class. He showed it's fine to fail at something, but if you collaborate with others and give your best, you'll succeed. This is a philosophy that stayed with the class as I began seeing more of his classmates attempting more questions and learning from their failures.

### **Personal Qualities**

- I also interacted with Jonathan in the Junior Achievers Club, where I was the patron. There, I got an insight into this enterprising young man determined to help underprivileged persons. He combined his love for cooking and business to initiate monthly food bazaars in the school. The food at the bazaars was nostalgic to the students as it reminded them of food they'd have at home thus many students bought the food. He led the club in using the profits to support low-income students like him in school by buying stationery, towels, soaps, and uniforms for them. Since I was on the Parent's Teachers Association board, I worked with him to double the scholarships offered by the school to low-income students.

### **RECOMMENDATION**

- Jonathan is one of the most outstanding students I've had the pleasure of teaching in my 18 years of experience. I can't think of any other student who is passionate about learning and helping others as much as Jonathan. He is determined as once he sets his mind to something, he'll go full tilt. His work ethic and level of commitment are impressive. He has constantly kept

me on my toes with questions that push me to explore more. I believe he'll continue with the same spirit in university as he interacts with his professors. He is a breath of fresh air and someone you wish crossed your path daily as he has a compliment in store for everyone. He'll be a great resource to his classmates in college, just like he was to Ali. I highly recommend him and hope you give him thorough consideration.

Sussy Musungu,  
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Light Academy.